

Xbox creator quits

It's not well with the Xbox. Its sales have been dropping and the last thing Microsoft needed at this point was for Seamus Blackley, co-creator of the Xbox, to resign. Blackley was the public face to fans and game developers for the Xbox. His influence helped Microsoft bag major game developers to develop titles for the Xbox. According to insider sources, Blackley

apparently wants to move on to other projects.



Although Xbox remains the number two console in the US, the scene's not so

pretty in Japan and Europe. Microsoft is biting the dust in Japan with Nintendo and Sony leading in sales and in Europe it's faring no better. As a last ditch attempt to push sales, Microsoft has cut Xbox prices from \$425 to \$265 in Europe.

If this trend continues, Microsoft will have a hard time recovering costs. So is this the writing on the wall for the Xbox?

Intel launches 533 MHz P4 processors

The new Pentium 4 stalions from the Intel stalions are out and they go on to prove that Intel still firmly believes in the age-old adage that 'Speed is everything'. The lead runner amongst these CPUs is the P4 2.53 GHz that is almost 800 MHz faster than AMD's speediest offering. There's also the Pentium 2.26 GHz and the Pentium 2.4B GHz. Additionally, Intel launched the new

i850E chipset that offers a faster 533 MHz front side bus (FSB) as compared to the previous speed of 400 MHz. The 850E chipset will also support the newer and faster 1066 MHz RDRAM.

These new processors have widened the frequency gap between the P4 and the AMD



Athlon XP, and the 533 MHz FSB gives the P4 an additional edge. AMD now needs to catch up and fast. Their only real hope is their new Athlon Thoroughbred CPUs that will use a 0.13 micron manufacturing technology, allowing them to ramp up their CPU speeds.

New cat OS from Apple

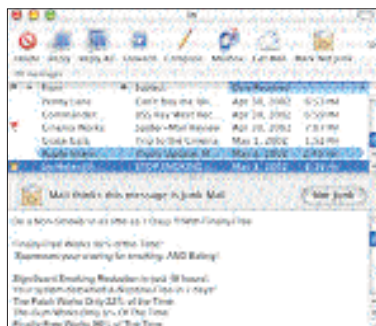
Apple always does things with élan. The unveiling of OS X 10.2 was no different. Christened the 'Jaguar', OS X 10.2's launch

started off with a burial. Yes, Steve Jobs started off with a mock funeral complete with a large silver coffin of the arcane but trusty OS 9.

Jaguar has several improvements and many additional features over the current OS X. The most prominent among them are iChat and Rendezvous.

iChat is a chat program with AOL compatibility and several additional features. It has a local buddy list for networks.

This feature allows the messenger to automatically add all the users available on a network. Rendezvous is a networking feature that makes it possible for Macs to connect automatically to each other without any intervention from the user. It even allows for connection between Macs with wireless capabilities. Another feature is Quartz Extreme, which gives the Macs greater graphics capabilities with the addition of next-generation video cards.



heroes

Sony
Sony Pictures is getting into the production of computer-animated films. Sandra Rabins and Penney Finkelman Cox, the people behind the runaway hit *Shrek*, will head this new division.

eMac
Apple has launched the eMac (based on the iMac) for the education segment. Loaded with goodies such as a 17-inch monitor and a G4 processor, it's intended for use in schools and other educational institutions. The eMac falls into the \$1,000-\$1,200 segment.

zeroes

Internet taxes
The European Union to approve a bill that will tax all software downloads from European servers.

P2P services
File sharing programs such as Audiogalaxy and KaZaA have a form of spyware embedded in them that can transmit information such as credit card numbers.

snapshot

91% of Fortune 500 companies use their corporate Web sites for recruiting purposes

Source: iLogos Research



out ■ RedHat 7.3 released ■ Xbox emulator floating on the Net is a Trojan horse ■ AMD announces improvement in flash-memory design